

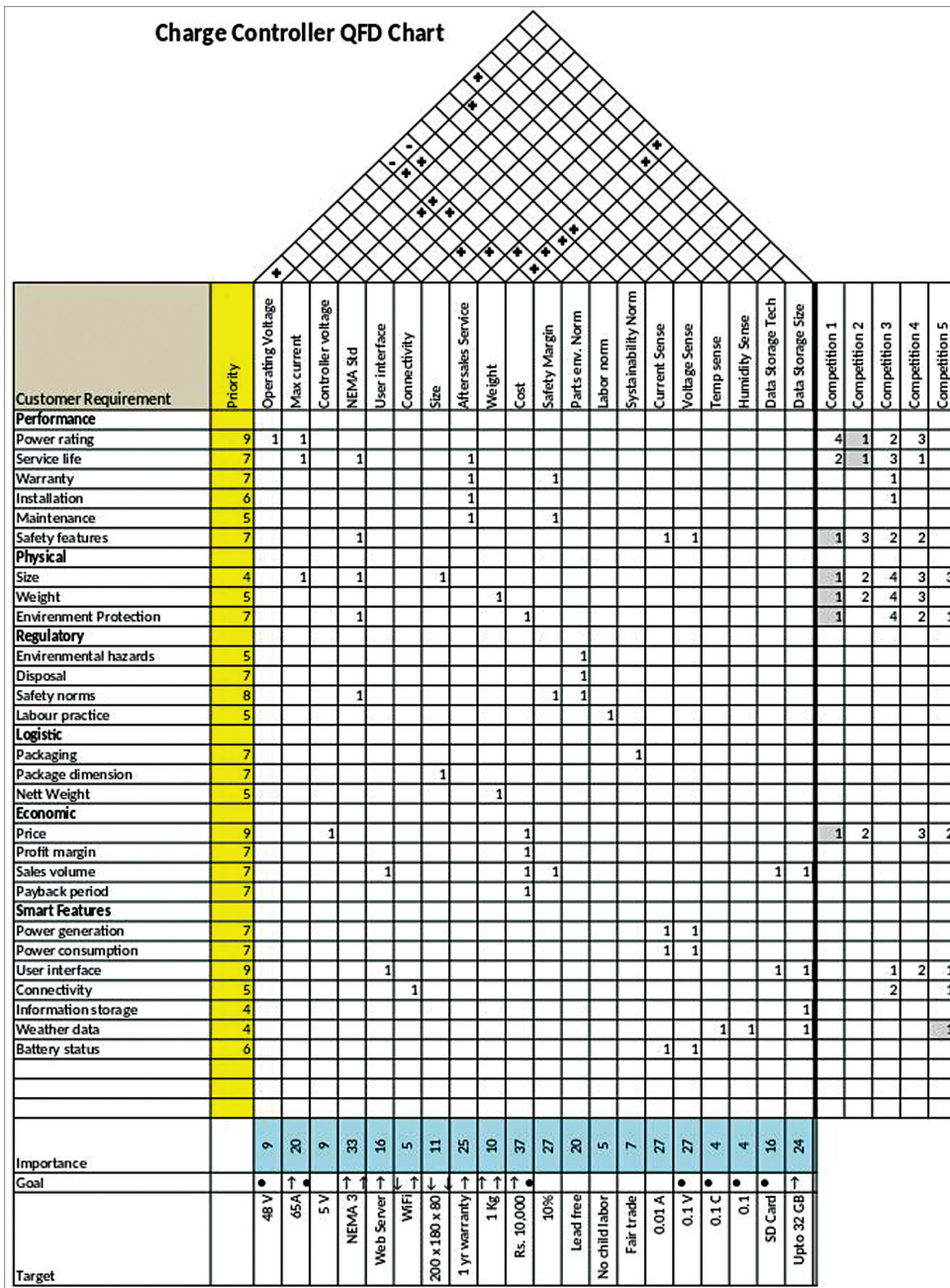


Fig. 3: Product specification QFD

priority number and product feature mapping.

These numbers tell us which of the product features are very important and which are not so important. The importance ranking is required to save time and highlight the important features of the product.

The next task of the QFD process

is to find the interactions between different product features. Some features are positively co-related whereas some other features may be negatively correlated. For instance, we may use drivers with higher power ratings to make our product robust and reliable, but that higher-rated item may be costly, which will diminish the attraction of our

product. Clarity on how different product features are related is an important step before we decide on the target specifications of our product.

To decide on the target specifications, we need to use the feature importance number. Important features should be decided after careful study and prototyping. Target on less important features may be decided based on a comparative feature study of the competition.

We start with various requirements of the product, such as:

Performance. Power rating, service life, reliability, installation, and maintenance

Physical. Size, weight, environment

Regulatory. Environmental hazards, safety norms, disposal

Logistic. Packaging, protection, physical dimensions

Economic. Price, profit margin, sales volume

Apart from these basic requirements we also need to provide features that make the product attractive. In our previous article we explained how we can increase the attraction of our charge converter by making it smart. We need

to consider those interactive features as well.

At the end of careful consideration of various product features, we finally get a list of the required product features. QFD process captures the information and the final outcome in a single chart and clearly shows how the product requirements are addressed by prod-